

English 01: Coherence and Cohesion

Conducted By

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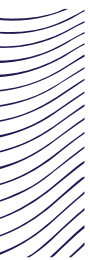
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definition

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Exercise: mini text... (groups of 3)-15 mins

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Definition

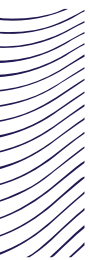
Coherence

- ➡ Macro level of features of a text which help it to make sense as a whole
- ➡ Patterns of organization
- ➡ Logically ordered and connected
- ➡ Clear and consistent
- ➡ Understandable
- ➡ Maintain a flow

Cohesion

- ➡ Micro level of a text, i.e., the words and sentences and how they join or link together
- ➡ United and working together
- ➡ Fitting together well
- ➡ Language glue





Coherence: Within section

- ☞ Organization of ideas
- ☞ Flow of paragraphs
- ☞ Paragraph structure
- ☞ Links between paragraphs
- ☞ Explicit relation to overall map (meta-)



Coherence: Paragraph structure and para-internal flow

- ☞ Topic sentence= main statement of a para
- ☞ Support sentences: develop/detail topic
- ☞ Final mini-summary/mini-conclusion
 - ☞ “therefore, hence, thus, consequently.... ”
- ☞ Link?



Coherence: Topic sentence example

The inclusion of external data, especially RDF data, however, raises several challenges for integration and transformation in comparison to the traditional ETL process. One of the drawbacks of using RDF data in the corporate analysis process is that the data sometimes do not have any schema, or only have a poor or complex schema. Moreover, different sources describe the data in their own way, introducing heterogeneity problems. Therefore, to build a successful data warehouse system with these heterogeneous data, the integration process should emphasize the semantic relationship of the data. Traditional ETL tools are unable to process such external data because they (1) do not support semantic-aware data, (2) are entirely schema-dependent, (3) do not focus on meaningful semantic relationships to integrate data from disparate sources [4], and (4) do not support deriving new information by active inference and reasoning on the data. Thus, a DW with both internal and external (semantic) data requires more powerful tools to define, integrate and transform data semantically.



Coherence Trick: Write mini-text FIRST to keep overview

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- 👉 Create outline first
- 👉 Create topic sentences for each para
- 👉 Check topic sentences tell a 'story' in themselves
- 👉 Start writing your full paragraphs around each topic sentence.



Exercise: mini text... (groups of 3)-15 mins

- 👉 You are writing a brief non-technical article on “The ways we harm ourselves”
- 👉 Write a ‘mini plan’ for the main body of a 6 paragraph article
 - 👉 Remember that each paragraph will be built out of one sentence from the mini plan
- 👉 Criteria:
 - 👉 Coherent ‘story’ in mini-plan
 - 👉 Expandability of each paragraph topic sentence



Cohesion: Within section

Good cohesion is achieved through the following five main methods:

- ☞ Reference words
- ☞ Repeated words/ idea
- ☞ Transition signals
- ☞ Substitution
- ☞ Ellipsis



Cohesion: Reference words

Reference words

- ☞ Do not make sense on their own
- ☞ Refer to something else in the text
- ☞ For example: this, that, these, those, they, he, she, them

*Cohesion is an important feature of academic writing. **It** can help ensure that your writing coheres or 'sticks together', **which** will make it easier for the reader to follow the main ideas in your essay or report. You can achieve good cohesion by paying attention to five important features. The first of **these** is repeated words. The second key feature is reference words. The third one is transition signals. The fourth is substitution. The final important aspect is ellipsis.*



Cohesion: Repetition and Relaxicalisation

- ☞ Repeat words or ideas using different words (synonyms)
- ☞ For example: My uncle gave me a very cute puppy. The puppy is now for sale. This tiny and destructive creature ate holes in my sofa and curtains. 'Dog for sale' it says on the sign in my window.

Cohesion is an important feature of academic writing. It can help ensure that your writing coheres or 'sticks together', which will make it easier for the reader to follow the main ideas in your essay or report. You can achieve good cohesion by paying attention to five important features. The first of these is repeated words. The second key feature is reference words. The third one is transition signals. The fourth is substitution. The final important aspect is ellipsis.



Cohesion: Repetition and Relaxicalisation

- ☞ Shell (carrier) nouns summarize the meaning of preceding or succeeding information.
- ☞ Examples: approach, aspect, category, challenge, change, characteristics, class, difficulty, effect, event, fact, factor, feature, form, issue, manner, method, problem, process, purpose, reason, result, stage, subject, system, task, tendency, trend, and type
- ☞ They are often used with pronouns 'this', 'these', 'that' or 'those', or with the definite article 'the'.
 - ☞ For example: An increasing number of overseas students are attending university in the UK. This trend has led to increased support networks for overseas students.
 - ☞ Virus transmission can be reduced via frequent washing of hands, use of face masks, and isolation of infected individuals. These methods, however, are not completely effective and transmission may still occur, especially among health workers who have close contact with infected individuals.



Cohesion: Repetition and Relaxicalisation

☞ Thematic development

☞ The term *theme* refers to the first element of a sentence or clause.

☞ The development of the theme in the rest of the sentence is called the rheme.

☞ Use rheme of one sentence to form the theme of the next sentence.

☞ Example:

Virus transmission can be reduced via frequent washing of hands, use of face masks, and isolation of infected individuals. These methods, however, are not completely effective and transmission may still occur, especially among health workers who have close contact with infected individuals. It is important for such health workers to pay particular attention to transmission methods and undergo regular screening.



Cohesion: Substitution

☞ Use one or more words to replace (substitute) for one or more words used earlier in the text

☞ The most common words used for substitution are one, so, and auxiliary verbs such as do, have and be

☞ Example:

Drinking alcohol before driving is illegal in many countries, since **doing so** can seriously impair one's ability to drive safely.

The dogs were watching him. **One** came over to lick his hand, but **the other**...

Jane beat the dog. Dave did the **same thing**.



Cohesion: Ellipsis

- ☞ An element is left out & supplied by the reader on the basis of the context. The reader actively co-constructs the text - without even thinking about it!
- ☞ Without it, our writing would be awkward and 'wordy'! The most common words used for substitution are one, so, and auxiliary verbs such as do, have and be
- ☞ Example:

Since the short story format includes a wide range of genres and styles, the actual length is determined by ...
Where is ellipsis?



Cohesion: Transition signals(Time)

- ☞ Logical relation- conjunctions: but, and, yet, nor, later, sooner, so, consequently, however, because
- ☞ Divided into various types: see for more <https://www.eapfoundation.com/writing/cohesion/transitions/>
- ☞ Logical cohesion: time
 - ☞ Before, During. After, While, Since, At the moment, By then, First, Next, Then

It was World War Two. Many people were killed. The population has recovered. It exceeds 53,000 million.



Cohesion: Example and addition

☞ Example and addition:

☞ For example,

☞ Generally speaking,

☞ In most cases,

☞ Occasionally,

☞ Especially,

☞ For instance,

☞ Specifically,

☞ Frequently,

☞ Sometimes,

☞ Moreover,

☞ and,

☞ also,

☞ Besides,

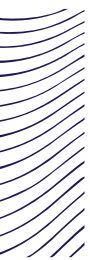
☞ First, second, third... finally,

☞ In addition,

☞ Furthermore,

☞ Moreover





Cohesion: Example and addition

People are afraid of the unknown. My father will not travel to foreign countries. He refuses to try new types of food



Cohesion: Contrast/similarity

☞ On the contrary, (strong)

☞ On the other hand,

☞ However,

☞ Unlike (with noun phrase)...

☞ Nonetheless,

☞ Nevertheless,

☞ Whereas

☞ Even though...

☞ Although....

☞but...

☞ ...yet...

☞ Regardless,

☞ Similarly,

☞ Likewise,

☞ Once again,

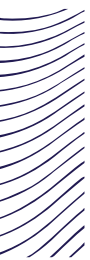
☞ by the same token

☞ in like manner

☞ in the same way

☞ in similar fashion





Cohesion: Contrast/similarity

Smokers know that tobacco is lethal. They go on smoking. We know that global warming is probably related to the consumption of fossil fuels. Many of us drive cars to work.



Cohesion: cause/effect

☞ Therefore

☞ Consequently

☞ Because

☞ Since

☞ As a result

☞ Due to

☞ For this reason

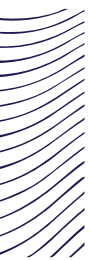
☞ Hence

☞ Thus

☞ Accordingly,

☞ And so





Cohesion: cause/effect

Iran and Iraq stopped producing oil. There was a shortage of fuel. Far more commuters began to use trains.



Cohesion: conclusion and summary

☞ Finally

☞ In brief

☞ In other words

☞ In closing

☞ In conclusion

☞ On the whole

☞ To conclude

☞ To summarize

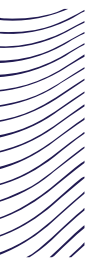
☞ In short

☞ In simpler terms

☞ That is

☞ To put it differently

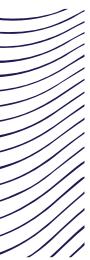




Cohesion: conclusion and summary

The enemy is weak, but tomorrow it will be stronger than we are. This is the time to attack. It would be mad to hesitate when we have the advantage.





Acknowledgement

<https://www.eapfoundation.com/writing/cohesion/>





Thank You

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